

extra automation like auto-SEO or auto-responsiveness, or even a whole e-commerce module. You can view the range once you pick your tools. Other than the innards (code creation), another important facet taken care of by the CMS is the outer appearance. The ability to use templates and themes greatly streamlines the amount of time and choices to a great design. It is not possible to give too much general information about CMSs because each is unique in its own way (except the blatant rip-offs of course), but that's what this chapter is for! Read on so we can help you choose the CMS that will be right for your needs!

Hunt for the Holy CMS

While there are many CMSs, some paid and some free like Wild Apricot, eXo Platform, and Smartimage, there are three very popular completely free options namely, Wordpress, Joomla and Drupal. Of course, they are only free because there are some in-app purchases, but all costs can be avoided with adequate effort and ingenuity. Other advantages include the fact that they are very powerful in terms of functionality. Their popularity ensures that documentation will be user-friendly and the product will continue to be developed to stay relevant. Free help is available for any kind of trouble after a quick search query, and there's no dearth of paid support. Moreover, the number of themes available will also be proportional to the popularity, a sure-fire customization bonus!

Drupal

The Drupal Project is completely Open Source, so anyone can download and share it. It is the most powerful and developer friendly CMS out there, and also one of the most secure. No wonder it is used by the official websites of the government of Trinidad and Tobago, the White House and the University of Chicago to name a few. The price of this awesomeness is a steep learning curve and a good amount of



Drupal: The cool CMS with the cool logo

technical knowledge and concepts to be grasped. Additionally, as part of the price, this CMS suffers the drawback of having a long installation process, with multiple important intermediate steps from zero to launch. That being said, Drupal is a great choice of CMS for creating and maintaining a top-